

Special Creation Of Humanity

doc-special-creation-of-humanity
Anthropology · Historicity · doctrine · divided_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus applies

Statement under examination

Adam and Eve were specially created by God and are not the product of unguided evolutionary processes.

In plain language

Genesis tells the origin of Adam and Eve with a cluster of verbs that name God as the personal agent. 'To create' (bara), the creation verb the Hebrew Bible reserves for God (a query of all its occurrences finds no human or natural subject), appears three times in Genesis 1:27 with the human as the direct object. Before that, Genesis 1:26 uses a deliberate 'let us make' (naaseh), not the impersonal commands of earlier days, and assigns the human the 'image' (tselem) and 'likeness' (demuth) of God, which nothing else receives. 'To form' (yatsar), the potter verb, shapes the man from 'dust' (aphar) in Genesis 2:7, and God 'blows' (naphach) the 'breath' (neshamah) of life into his nostrils, at which point the man becomes a living being. 'To build' (banah), the building verb, makes the woman from the man's side. Psalm 100:3 adds the plain negation, 'he made us and not we ourselves', and the New Testament keeps the same grammar: Jesus says the creator made them 'male and female' (arsen kai thelu, echoing zakar and neqebah, Matthew 19:4) and Paul says Adam was first formed, using the Greek verb 'to mold or shape' (plasso) that translates the Hebrew potter verb yatsar (1 Timothy 2:13). So the words decisively say humanity is God's deliberate work, not a self-originating accident. Why do careful readers still divide? The divergence is lexical, not historical. The very verb used of forming the man, yatsar, is also used of God forming a person in the womb (Jeremiah 1:5, Isaiah 44:2, Psalm 139:16), and that forming clearly runs through an ordinary process over time. The same word, dust, and the verb to breathe are common terms whose strong creation sense here comes from context. So the vocabulary settles who acts and that the act is deliberate and personal, but it does not by itself state the physical manner, whether the forming was instantaneous or worked through a means. One reading takes the verbs as immediate, hands-on acts. The other reads them as affirming divine agency while leaving the mechanism open. Both reject an unguided, agentless origin, which is the heart of what the proposition claims, and that is why the verdict affirms.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0120	אָדָם	adam	man	562
H0127	אֲדָמָה	adamah	land	
H0802	אִשָּׁה	ishshah	woman	
H1129	בָּנָה	banah	to build	340
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	46
H1823	דְּמוּת	demuth	likeness	24
H2145	זָכָר	zakar	male	80

H2416	חַיָּה	chay	alive	
H3318	יָצָא	yatsa	to come out	
H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	61
H5301	נָפַח	naphach	to breathe	11
H5347	נִקְבָּה	neqebah	female	22
H5397	נְשָׁמָה	neshamah	breath	23
H5462	סָגַר	sagar	to shut	
H6083	עָפָר	aphar	dust	97
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	
H6754	צֶלֶם	tselem	image	16
H6763	צֶלַע	tsela	side	40
H8639	תַּרְדֵּמָה	tardemah	deep sleep	7
G2936	κτίζω	ktizo	to create	15
G4111	πλάσσω	plasso	to mold	2
G4160	ποιέω	poieō	to do/make	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern across Genesis 1:26-27, Genesis 2:7, and Genesis 2:21-22 names God as the direct and personal agent of humanity's origin, and the witness reaches the New Testament. Four verbs carry the load: the Hebrew verb 'to create' (bara, H1254A, queried across all 39 verses with God as the only subject) creates the human and is repeated three times in Genesis 1:27 with the human as the direct object marked by the Hebrew accusative particle *eth* (the small word that flags 'this is the thing being acted on'); 'to form' or 'to mold like a potter' (yatsar, H3335, the potter verb) forms the man from dust; 'to blow' or 'breathe' (naphach, H5301) blows the breath of life into his nostrils; 'to build' (banah, H1129) builds the woman from his side. Matthew 19:4 (using 'to create', ktizo, and 'to make', poieo) and 1 Timothy 2:13 (using 'to mold or shape', plasso, the Greek mirror of yatsar) restate Adam and the man-female pair as a divine making, so the spread is pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible). The reading that the words affirm divine agency without specifying biological mechanism is also lexically defensible, since 'to form' (yatsar) is used of God forming individuals in the womb (Jeremiah 1:5, Isaiah 44:2, Psalm 139:16), which is a real mediate process (one that runs through a means). The affirmed point (direct divine agency) is decisive; the question of mechanism is what the vocabulary underdetermines (leaves open).

Scripture

Gen.1.26 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H6213A עָשָׂה, H6754 צֶלֶם, H1823 דְמוּת; H0120 אָדָם.

Reasoning. The clause 'let us make man' (naaseh adam) uses a deliberate first-person volitive (a 'let us do this' verb form expressing intention) of 'to make' (asah), which sets the human-making apart from the impersonal jussives (third-person command forms, 'let there be') that produce the prior days. The pair 'image' (tselem) and 'likeness' (demuth) assigns the human a categorial likeness to God that no other created thing receives. The verb here names intention and personal resolve, not a process. It tells who acts and with what purpose, but it does not by itself specify the physical manner of execution.

Gen.1.27 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1254A בָּרָא, H6754 יָצַלַם, H2145 זָכַר, H5347 נִקְבָּה

Reasoning. 'To create' (bara) occurs three times in this single verse with God (Elohim) as subject and the human as direct object marked by the accusative particle 'eth' (the small Hebrew word that flags the thing being acted on). A direct query of all 39 verses where 'to create' (bara, H1254A) appears confirms that it never takes a human or natural subject in the canon, it is reserved for divine action. 'Male' (zakar) and 'female' (neqebah) are both named at the originating creation event, not introduced as a later branch. The grammar fixes God as the agent. It does not in this verse describe the bodily steps of the making.

Gen.2.7 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3335 יָצַר, H6083 עָפַר, H5301 נָפַח, H5397 נִשְׁמָחָה

Reasoning. 'And he formed' (wayyitser, from yatsar) is the potter verb. God forms the man of 'dust' (aphar) from the ground, then 'blows' (naphach) the 'breath' (neshamah) of life into his nostrils, and only at that point does the man become a living 'soul' or 'being' (nephesh). The clause order makes the divine breath the proximate cause (the immediate or direct cause) of human animation. A full concordance pull of 'to form' (yatsar) (54 distinct verses) shows the same verb used of God forming the prophet in the womb (Jeremiah 1:5) and forming Israel from the womb (Isaiah 44:2, Isaiah 44:24, Isaiah 49:5), processes that unfold through ordinary gestation, so 'to form' (yatsar) names personal divine craftsmanship without fixing whether the forming is immediate or works through a means.

Gen.2.21 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H8639 תַּרְדֵּמָה, H6763 צָלַע, H5462 סָגַר

Reasoning. 'Deep sleep' (tardemah) is a divinely induced deep sleep, the same noun used in Genesis 15:12 of the covenant theophany (a visible appearance of God) with Abram (confirmed by query, 7 occurrences total). God takes a 'side' or 'rib' (tsela) from the man and 'closes' (sagar) flesh in its place. The verbs narrate a concrete, intentional, hands-on act rather than a figurative cause or a gradual emergence.

Gen.2.22 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1129 בָּנָה, H6763 צָלַע, H0802 אָשָׂה

Reasoning. 'To build' or 'to construct' (banah) (340 occurrences, normally of houses, cities, and altars) governs the formation of the 'woman' (ishshah) from the 'side' (tsela) material taken from the man. The grammar makes the woman a derived but discrete act of divine construction with God as the named builder, not a parallel line that arose on its own.

Gen.2.19 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3335 יָצַר, H0127 אָדָמָה

Reasoning. The same verb 'and he formed' (wayyitser, from yatsar) used of the man in Genesis 2:7 is also used here of the land animals and birds, formed by God from the 'ground' (adamah). This shows that the forming verb alone is not what marks the human as special. What is not repeated for any animal is the breathing of God's own 'breath' (neshamah) and the threefold 'to create' (bara) of Genesis 1:27. This text complicates a naive reading that leans only on 'to form' (yatsar), and it also constrains the evolutionary reading, because the animals too are said to be formed directly by God from the ground.

Gen.1.24 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3318 יצא, H2416E תיה

Reasoning. The land animals are produced by a mediated formula (one that works through a means), 'let the earth bring forth' (totse haarets), using the Hebrew causative form (to cause to do) of 'to go out' or 'come forth' (yatsa). This is a different construction from the human-making, which uses 'to create' (bara) plus the accusative-marked 'eth-adam' (the-man-as-direct-object) and the personal 'let us make' (naaseh). The contrast within Genesis 1 itself, mediated bringing-forth for the animals versus direct creation language for the human, sharpens rather than weakens the directness claimed for the human.

Gen.3.19 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H6083 עפר, H0127 אדמה

Reasoning. The judgment oracle confirms the Genesis 2:7 origin by returning the man to the 'dust' (aphar) he was taken from, 'for dust you are' (ki apha' attah). The 'dust' (aphar) idiom is treated as a real statement of where the man came from, not as poetic dress, and it assumes the original forming as an actual event.

Gen.5.1 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1823 דמות, H0120 אדם

Reasoning. The 'generations' header (toledoth, the Hebrew genealogical heading 'these are the generations of') of 'man' or 'Adam' (adam) restates that on the day God created 'man' (adam) he made him in the 'likeness' (demuth) of God. The genealogical header treats Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 as a single historical origin point for the human line, with God as maker.

Jer.1.5 · **neutral** · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר

Reasoning. 'Before I formed you' ('to form', yatsar) 'in the womb I knew you'. Here the identical potter verb describes God forming an individual person through ordinary gestation 'in the womb' (ba-beten). This is the strongest lexical basis for the reading that 'to form' (yatsar) affirms personal divine forming without by itself excluding a mediate biological means (a means that works through a process in time). It does not overturn the directness in Genesis, but it shows the verb does not settle the question of mechanism.

Isa.44.2 · **neutral** · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H6213A עשה

Reasoning. 'The LORD your maker' (osekha, from asah) 'and your former' (yotserkha, from yatsar) 'from the womb' (mi-beten). The same verb pair, 'to make' (asah) and 'to form' (yatsar), that operates in the Genesis human-making is here applied to God forming a person from the womb. This is part of the lexical evidence that the forming vocabulary asserts divine agency over a person's origin while remaining compatible with a process that runs in time.

Ps.139.16 · **neutral** · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3335 יצר

Reasoning. 'My days were formed' ('to form', yatsar, in the Hebrew passive form) 'when as yet there were none'. The verb of Genesis 2:7 is used of the shaping of a life across time. This further shows that 'to form' (yatsar) names God's purposeful forming of a person without specifying an instantaneous manner, which is the genuine point the Genesis vocabulary leaves open.

Job.27.3 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H5397 נְשָׁמָה

Reasoning. Job locates his own continuing life in the 'breath' (neshamah) in his nostrils and the 'spirit' (ruach) of 'God' (Eloah), recycling the exact Genesis 2:7 vocabulary. The wisdom text treats the Genesis 2:7 breath as the ongoing description of every living human, which presses the originating divine breath as a real cause and not a figure.

Gen.7.22 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5397 נְשָׁמָה, H2416E תִּיה

Reasoning. The flood narrative uses 'the breath of the spirit of life' (neshamath ruach chayyim) in the nostrils to describe what dies, presupposing the Genesis 2:7 source of that breath as the common origin of human and creaturely life.

Isa.43.7 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H1254A בָּרָא, H3335 יָצַר, H6213A עָשָׂה

Reasoning. Isaiah stacks all three Genesis verbs on the same human object, 'I created him' (beratiw, from bara), 'I formed him' (yetsartiw, from yatsar), 'indeed I made him' (aph asitiw, from asah). The triple chain gathers the Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 vocabulary together and insists that God is the agent of the human's existence. The piling of synonyms intensifies the agency claim without itemizing the physical steps.

Ps.100.3 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H6213A עָשָׂה

Reasoning. 'He made us' (asanu, from asah) 'and not we ourselves'. The negation places the cause of human existence outside human agency and assigns it to God as maker. It directly excludes a self-originating account, which is the contrast the proposition's negation targets.

Matt.19.4 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G2936 κτίζω, G4160 ποιέω

Reasoning. Jesus says 'the one who created' (ho ktisas, from ktizo, 'to create') 'from the beginning made them' (epoiesen autous, from poieo, 'to make') 'male and female' (arsen kai thelu), directly echoing the 'male' (zakar) and 'female' (neqebah) of Genesis 1:27. This carries the same agent-and-act grammar into the New Testament and attributes the male and female pairing to a personal creator at the beginning, which gives the doctrine an Old Testament and New Testament spread.

1Tim.2.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4111 πλάσσω

Reasoning. 'Adam was first formed' (protos eplasthe, a completed past action from plasso, 'to mold or shape'), then Eve. 'To mold or shape' (plasso) is the standard Greek mold-or-shape verb and the regular rendering in the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint) of 'to form' (yatsar). Applying 'he was formed' (eplasthe) to Adam restates the Genesis 2:7 potter-forming in Greek and ties the New Testament directly to the Genesis vocabulary, with God as the implied forming agent.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Gen.2.21	Gen.15.12	tsk	1
Gen.2.22	Gen.2.19	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Gen.2.21	tsk	1

Gen.2.7	Gen.3.19	tsk	1
Gen.1.26	Gen.5.1	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Job.27.3	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Ps.100.3	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Gen.7.22	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Isa.43.7	openbible	1
Gen.1.27	Matt.19.4	openbible	1
Gen.1.26	Ps.100.3	openbible	1
Gen.1.26	Acts.17.26	openbible	1
Gen.1.27	Ps.139.14	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Gen.2.19 · addressed

The animals are also formed ('to form', yatsar) by God from the ground, so the forming verb alone does not single out the human. The distinguishing features are the threefold 'to create' (bara) of Genesis 1:27, the accusative-marked direct object (the 'eth'-marked human as the thing acted on), the image-and-likeness assignment, and God breathing his own 'breath' (neshamah) into the man, none of which is repeated for any animal. The human special-creation reading therefore rests on the cluster, not on 'to form' (yatsar) by itself.

Jer.1.5 · addressed

'To form' (yatsar) is used of God forming an individual 'in the womb' (ba-beten), a process that runs through ordinary gestation, and the same womb-forming use appears in Isaiah 44:2, Isaiah 44:24, Isaiah 49:5, and Psalm 139:16. This shows the verb predicates personal divine agency over a person's origin but does not by itself fix whether the forming is instantaneous or works through a means. The proposition's affirmed core (direct divine agency) holds; the additional claim about excluding any mediate process is what the vocabulary leaves open. This is recorded as a genuine, fairly stated competing lens rather than a defeater.

Gen.1.24 · addressed

Land animals are produced by the mediated 'let the earth bring forth' (totse haarets) formula, which is grammatically distinct from the direct 'to create' (bara) plus 'let us make' (naaseh) language used of the human. The contrast supports the directness claimed for the human-making and does not undercut it.

Concordance traversed

H1254A, H3335, H5301, H5397, H1129, H6754, H1823, H6083, H6763, H8639, H2145, H5347, H0120, H0127, H6213A, G4111, G2936, G4160

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The anchor verses are in Genesis, outside the ingested ECM apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John). Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 sit in the Masoretic and Samaritan Pentateuch consonantal stream (the unpointed Hebrew consonant text shared across these two manuscript traditions) with no variant readings that touch the 'to create' (bara), 'to form' (yatsar), 'to blow' (naphach), 'breath' (neshamah), 'side' (tsela), or 'to build' (banah) anchors. The New Testament witnesses cited (Matthew 19:4 with 'to create' (ktizo) and 'to make' (poieo), 1 Timothy 2:13 with 'to mold or shape' (plasso)) have no variant that changes which creation verb is used. CBGM (the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, a computational tool for tracing manuscript relationships) is not applicable to these verses.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. young_earth_creationism, old_earth_creationism, theistic_evolution, framework_hypothesis

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

direct_special_creation: affirms · Reads the verb cluster ('to create' (bara) three times, the personal 'let us make' (naaseh), 'to form' (yatsar) from dust, 'to blow' (naphach) of the breath, 'to build' (banah) of the woman from the rib) as discrete, hands-on divine acts that produced the first human pair immediately, with the contrast against the mediated 'let the earth bring forth' (totse haarets) of the animals and the unique image-and-likeness assignment confirming that the human origin is told as a direct creative event rather than the terminus (end-point) of a natural sequence.

divine_agency_without_specified_mechanism: affirms_agency · Agrees that the words make God the personal agent of humanity's origin, but holds that the same verbs do not by themselves specify the physical manner. The strongest lexical support is that 'to form' (yatsar), the Genesis 2:7 verb, is used of God forming individuals in the womb (Jeremiah 1:5, Isaiah 44:2, Isaiah 44:24, Isaiah 49:5, Psalm 139:16), a process that unfolds through ordinary gestation, and that 'dust' (aphar) and 'to blow' or 'breathe' (naphach) are common-language terms whose Genesis 2:7 sense comes from context. On this reading the text decisively affirms that humanity is God's deliberate work and not self-originating, while leaving the biological mechanism unaddressed by the vocabulary itself. This lens still rejects an unguided, agentless account, because Psalm 100:3 ('he made us, not we ourselves') and the accusative-marked 'to create' (bara) of Genesis 1:27 (with the human as 'eth'-marked direct object) keep God as the cause.

The proposition has two parts: a positive claim (specially created by God) and a negation (not the product of unguided processes). Both competing lenses affirm the positive divine-agency claim and both reject an unguided, self-originating account, so the verdict affirms on the part the lexis (the vocabulary itself) decides. The lenses differ only on whether the vocabulary also forecloses any mediate process (any process that works through a means in time), which is the point the words underdetermine (leave open). Chronology frameworks (young earth, old earth, framework) do not change the agency reading and are listed as frameworks_in_play but are not the axis of divergence.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem pairs a positive claim (Adam and Eve specially created by God) with a negation (not the product of unguided evolutionary processes). The negation names the actual contrast the lexis (the vocabulary itself) resolves, namely whether the verbs identify a deliberate divine agent or an agentless natural process, so it does not smuggle the verdict. The lexical pattern decides the agency question on its own terms. No rephrasing was needed. Affirms is unchanged from the prior file (still true); the enrichment deepened the underdetermination analysis (analysis of what the words leave open) and added the New Testament witnesses, it did not flip the verdict.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.7
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.19
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.22
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1254A
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3335
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5301
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1129
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5397

lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4111
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2936
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.26-27
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.7
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Tim.2.13
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Gen.2.7
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License audit

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Flags

(none)